

THE CAPABILITY THAT HASN'T TRAVELLED

Ngon Sam

藥安心 · peace of mind about medicine

Photograph a box. Confirm the product. Read sourced warnings —
and when we cannot verify a pair, it says so.

BAUHINIA SPHEAL · HKU · OCTOBER 2026 · NGON SAM = 安心, SAY IT "NG-ON SUM"

WHERE THE ADVICE RUNS OUT

The pharmacist is not there at 2 a.m.

Hong Kong's community pharmacy services are real and good. They simply cannot reach the kitchen table — or the caregiver who cannot read the label.

WHO THIS IS FOR

Two people who cannot read each other

OLDER ADULTS · CANTONESE

Several medicines, and an explanation they forget by dinner.

DOMESTIC HELPERS · ENGLISH

She handles the pills, not the reasoning. The label is blank to her.

So it reads the answer out loud — in Cantonese or in English.

— THE FEATURE BOTH OF THEM CAN USE

Five steps to a duplicated dose

THE CHAIN • LEFT TO RIGHT

01

Arrive

Medicines from several appointments

02

Explain

The explanation is not retained

03

Hand over

A caregiver who cannot read it

04

Judge

She decides for herself

05

Harm

Duplicated or missed doses

This is not an efficiency problem. It is a hospital admission problem.

TWO BOXES FROM ONE SHELF

Both boxes are paracetamol.

One treats a headache. The other is a cold and flu formulation. Both contain the same ingredient, and a caregiver would not catch it.

4,000 mg a day is the ceiling.
At 500 mg each, that is eight tablets.

— THE DAILY LIMIT

药 1 必理痛普通片 (绿色盒正面)



绿色主盒、白色 "Panadol Tablets Paracetamol 500mg" 字样。

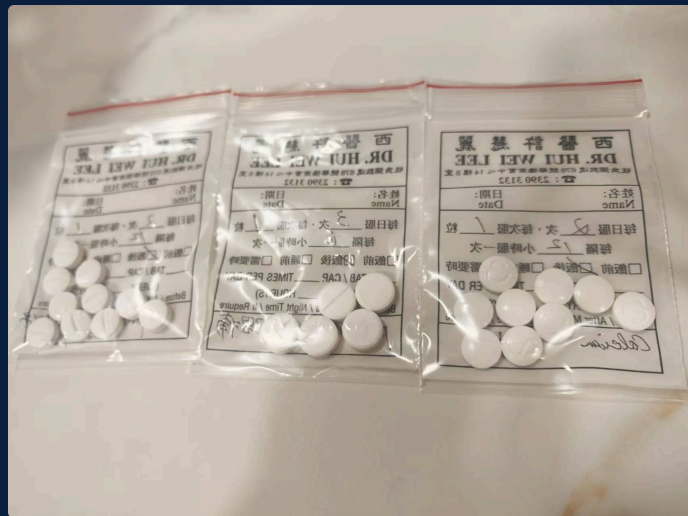
药 2 必理痛傷風感冒特強 (綠銀色盒正面)



WHAT THEY ARE HANDED

A bag lists the medicines. Not how to take them.

A bag lists the medicines. It does not say how they are taken at home.



The wrong medicine, or the wrong dose

Documented medication-error cases, in Hong Kong and internationally, end in the same two ways. The information did not travel with the patient.

Checking and escalation are the countermeasures.

— WHY WE BUILT A CHECKER, NOT A CHATBOT

新聞公報

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署理食物及衛生局局長關注病人服食錯誤配發藥物後死亡事件

署理食物及衛生局局長梁卓偉教授今日（七月十三日）表示，非常關注威爾斯親王醫院一名七十三歲女病人服用了錯誤配發的血壓藥物及糖尿病藥物後死亡一事，並向逝世女病人的家人致以深切慰問。

梁卓偉對這事件的發生表示十分遺憾，已責成醫院管理局（醫管局）即時徹查事件。

他表示，醫院員工必須嚴格遵守有關程序和指引，確保正確處理病人藥物，避免同類事件再次發生。同時，醫管局應檢討處理藥物的程序有否需要改善的地方。

完

2011年7月13日（星期三）

香港時間 21時42分

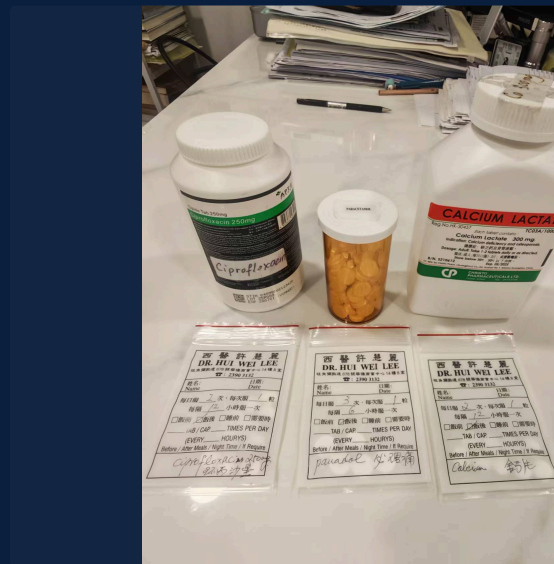
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READ IT CLEARLY

Three similar bottles. Three different medicines.

The user confirms the product.



ONLY THREE OUTCOMES

A warning is not a ban

01 · A WARNING FOUND

Shown at the strength its source supports.

02 · NO RULE FOUND

Said out loud. Sent to a pharmacist.

03 · A MEDICINE NOT IDENTIFIED

The check is incomplete, and it says so rather than guessing.

Warfarin with aspirin is a raised risk, not a ban. And whatever the outcome, it never calls a combination safe — nothing in it can.

THE MISTAKE WE WILL NOT MAKE

False reassurance is worse than no answer.

A first-line response should escalate, not guess.

Two numbers that matter

HONG KONG REGISTERED PRODUCTS

14,269

INGREDIENT RECORDS MAPPED

23,835

WHAT IS ALREADY OUT THERE

Plenty of tools look it up. Few of them check it.

WHAT EXISTS

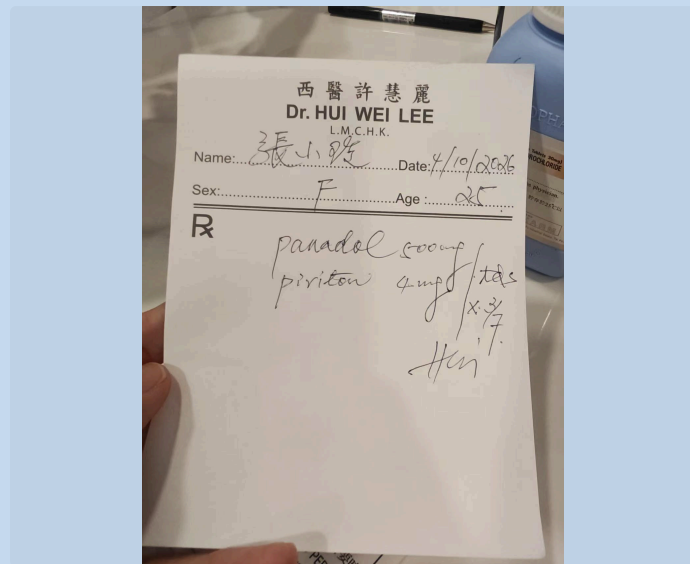
Chatbots need a signal and can be confidently wrong. Leaflets are accurate but unreadable at the kitchen table. Pharmacist services need a call and office hours.

OUR POSITION

Put the pharmacist's first sentence where it is needed. Hong Kong does not lack expertise — it lacks expertise at the kitchen table.

What still has to happen

We researched twenty high-risk combinations and kept the fourteen most representative; all fourteen are reviewed. What is not done is the part that needs other people: testing real packs against what the product says, timing it against asking a pharmacist now, and widening coverage past those fourteen pairs.



ONE LAST THING

It says “I don't know.”

Read it clearly. See the sourced warning. Take the gaps to a pharmacist.

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THANK YOU

— HACKU 2026 —